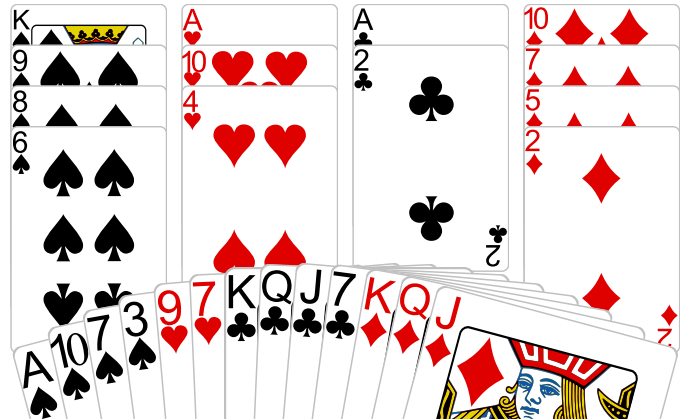


Deal 4 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Sure Winners				
				Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
				Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 7 5 3
♥ Q 6
♦ J 10 6 4
♣ K J 9 2

♠ K J

♥ 10 9 7 3

♦ A K 5 3

♣ A Q 4



♠ A 6 2

♥ K J 8 5 2

♦ 9 8

♣ 10 7 3

♠ Q 10 9 8 4

♥ A 4

♦ Q 7 2

♣ 8 6 5

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North

It is pretty clear that the 4 additional winners you need will be ♠s. The danger is that when you force out the ♠A the defenders might be able to cash 4 ♥s right away. So the immediate decision is whether you take the ♥A on the first trick or wait until the second.

If East has only 4 ♥s it will make no difference what you do because they will only win 3 ♥ tricks and you will make your contract. So assume that East has a 5-card suit, which means that West has 2 ♥s. East's suit is definitely **NOT** ♥ K Q J 5 2; he would have started with the ♥K, not the ♥5. So you can be sure that West holds either ♥ K x, ♥ Q x or ♥ J x. So what?

So you should play the ♥A immediately. If West puts on his small ♥ then his lone honor will block the suit the next time it is played. But if he unblocks the honor under dummy's ♥A then your ♥ 10 9 7 will be promoted into a second stopper.

If you play low on the first trick West will win the ♥Q and return the ♥6 to dummy's ♥A. When East gains the lead with his ♠A he will cash 3 more ♥ tricks. Down 1.

Play the ♥A on the first trick and West is hog-tied. If he plays low the suit blocks, if he sacrifices his ♥Q then your ♥ 10 9 7 prevents East from running the suit.

Partner's 2♥ is a transfer, so you bid 2♠. Partner now bids 2NT.

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Partner is only inviting, so he must have either 9 or 10 points. And since he chose 2NT as the invitation he must have only 5 ♠s. You will accept the invitation since you have a maximum 1NT opener, and you choose 3NT since you know there is no 8-card ♠ fit.

North plays 3NT. When East leads the ♥5 you have an immediate decision to make.

Winner List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 5

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 9 8 6
♥ A 10 4
♦ 10 7 5 2
♣ A 2

♠ Q J 4 2

♥ 8 3

♦ 9 8 3

♣ 10 8 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 10 7 3

♥ 9 7

♦ K Q J

♣ K Q J 7

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 6 5 2

♦ A 6 4

♣ 9 4 3

West	North	East	South
		1NT	2♥
2NT	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♥	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by East

cue-bid following the lebensohl 2NT also promises a stopper in the enemy suit. In any case, partner replies 3♠. Next?

You bid 4♠.

The contract would be 4♠ played by West.

East plays 4♠. South leads the ♥K. Do you take the first trick or not?

Loser List: ♠ = 1/2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 3/4

You should not hold up on the ♥ for two reasons. First, North might have a singleton. Second, you might not have a ♥ loser at all (if you can discard both of dummy's ♥ losers on your ♣s).

So win the ♥A and start on trumps by playing ♠A, then ♠K. Uh Oh. North discards a ♥ on the second ♠ so you have two ♠ losers.

Now you will have to be lucky. Leave the two master trumps undrawn and start running the ♣s. Fortunately North has 4 ♣s and you are able to discard both of dummy's ♥ losers. Play a ♦ next and your luck continues when it is South who takes the trick. Since North can't get in to pull your trumps, you cannot be defeated. You play your ♦ winners and ruff a ♥ in dummy. North will get his two trumps at the end.

Imagine what would have happened if you had played a third trump.

North would have taken the two trump tricks, then South would have taken 5 ♥ tricks and the ♦A.

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